



Yizkor 5779

A Sinless Yom Kippur

❖ Synopsis

While Ahskenazim say Yizkor on every holiday, the first documented mention to do a Yizkor service is on Yom Kippur. This leaves me quite perplexed, for the one day that seemingly has no connection to a pure soul in a pure Garden of Eden is Yom Kippur, the Day of Atonement for the stains of sin upon our souls.

The reason that we say Kaddish for only 11 months after a parent passes away is because our sages teach us that the cleansing process in the afterlife for the average person is up to 11 months, while for one worse than average it is for up to 12 months. We don't want to disrespect our parents, by insinuating that they are worse than average sinners, so we stop saying Kaddish at 11 months. Thus, after 12 months there is no soul in the afterlife that still has sin stains. Which leaves us wondering what is Yom Kippur all about for the souls in heaven?

Let us take this one step further. What will Yom Kippur be all about when Moshiach comes, the *Evil Inclination* was slain, and there exists no such thing as a sin for which we would have to atone for.

Now, let's bring it back home to us. The Laws of Teshuvah clearly state that Teshuvah is a *Shatoh Chodo v'Rigah Chodo* action. Meaning that Teshuvah is a one moment and one second action. The reason is because Teshuva is a mitzvah of the heart, which entails remorse and resolution. The Teshuvah realm of the heart transcends the lengthy process of time. It comes from a specific illumination of the *Pintelleh Yid* of our soul that shines into the heart, and we suddenly feel a true *Hirhur Teshuvah* – *Thought of Teshuvah*, realizing that all we want in life is to be one with G-d and to walk in G-d's ways. This realization creates a remorse for anything we did that betrayed our relationship with G-d, and a resolution to never repeat that betrayal again. And, voila, Teshivah was done.

It is most definite that already last night as we came to shul, heard the *Kol Nidrei*, and had a solemn moment with G-d that each and every one of us at some level experienced the *Hirhur Teshuvah*, and a drop of essence is all of essence, and thus, we entered into the entire experience of Yom Kippur and its power of *Teshuvah*. After which, to question whether G-d accepted that *Hirhur Teshuvah* of last night, is to question G-d's infinite compassion and G-d's gift of Yom Kippur. Thus, to do *Teshuvah* again for that which G-d already accepted, and for the sin that G-d already erased is like wiping up spilt milk which was already wiped up... Taking it a step further, doing *Teshuva* for a forgiven sin is to hold on to the sin with euphoric recall of shame. Not a G-dly thing at all, and definitely not what Yom Kippur is all about.

Well then, what is the rest of Yom Kippur, post *Hirhur Teshuvah*, all about? Which is the same question as how do the souls we say Yizkor for celebrate Yom Kippur, which is the same as the question of what will Yom Kippur be all about once Moshiach comes.





Okay, I won't keep it from you... This question actually started in me when I was in 770 Yom Kippur, saw the Rebbe crying, and wondered, *What is Yom Kippur to a sinless Tzaddik all about?*

The foundation of the question is that Yom Kippur only exists because mankind sins. The first Yom Kippur for the Jews was the day that Moses brought us the *Second Tablets*, and thus, were we forgiven for the sin of the golden calf that broke the *First Tablets*. However, there is a clear opinion amongst the counters of the 613 commandments that you can't count a commandment that only exists if we sin. Thus, Yom Kippur is not just for sinners, but for the pure souls in heaven, for the righteous upon earth, and for the utopic era of Moshiach, as well.

Teshuvah simply means to return, and we are talking about returning to within the bosom of G-d. Being that the bosom of G-d is infinite, thus, the return into our core source of existence within G-d is infinite.

Okay, so let's get real and practical with this.

Anthony Robbins and every one of his ilk speak of the need for an infinite, passion, burning, and tangible *want* for success. And that unless your want for success is like the want of a drowning man for a gulp of air, you will not be successful. However, to be successful, we need to then step away from that blinding passionate want, so that we can function within our logic to practically work the plans of how we are going to become successful. Then we have to walk away from the logic, and start feeling the feelings of excitement, for no action is propelled into actuality by logic, but by tangible feelings. Then we have to step away from the feelings of excitement so that we can begin making the phone calls, administrative work and meetings necessary to actually become successful.

So, you see, living life is all about getting further and further from the original blinding drive of want that was necessary to bring success.

However, then there are the times, especially when the road gets rough, monotonous, and we begin wondering if it's all worth it, that we need to re-experience the source of it all. That infinite passionate want with which we started.

Thus, the verse states, "*For the candle of G-d is the soul of man.*" The soul is like a flame. A flame is never still. Look closely and you will see that the flame keeps on jumping off the wick and then returns back to the wick. So, it is with the soul of man. To function on fulfilling the will of G-d in the universe the soul needs to descend from its source, shedding layer after layer of intensity, until it is left but with the mere functioning shallowness of practicality. After which, the soul must ascend layer after layer into its source of passion and oneness within the bosom of its Maker, to be rejuvenated.

The tears of the Rebbe on Yom Kippur were not tears of remorse, but rather, uncontrollable tears of yearning, as the Rebbe sensed the Yom Kippur presence of G-d. They were tears of an embrace from a



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Father who had sent the Rebbe far away to the distant darkness and coarseness of Earth on a mission. So it is for the souls in heaven, as they experience the Yom Kippur presence of G-d.

My friends, now we understand what Yizkor on Yom Kippur is all about. It is to remind us that Yom Kippur is not all about us and our shame of our sins. Rather, Yom Kippur is a beautiful day of yearning within the realms of purity, for an oneness with *Avinu Malkein –Our Father Our King*.

